



A phone of the kind you would install in your car a couple of decades ago

creation of a number of wireless communities, united by their passion for the waves (not the wet kind). One of these groups, called the *Mobileers*, decided to take to the road, removing their radio kits from their 'HAM Shacks' (outdoor sheds to house HAM radio sets) and rigging them to their cars and bicycles.

Another was the fact that the police and other emergency services had already been using a two-way radio system to communicate with their headquarters. Why not take this a step further and connect the radios to the telephone exchange?

They did exactly that and in 1946, the Swedish Police carried out the first trial of a mobile telephone system. Calls could be made from a police vehicle to a telephone at the exchange and the battery would last a few calls. The system was a Push-To-Talk (PTT)—push a button to talk and release it to listen. The system, titled simply the 'Mobile Telephone System' (MTS), was implemented in the US in the late 1940s. However, MTS was little more than a two-way radio system. A call from a mobile police radio needed to be 'patched' through to the telephone network by an operator. While the equipment added around 35 kilos to the weight of the police car, it cost as much as the car itself and had only three channels (lines of communication), which meant that only three calls were possible at a time.